Patients Bring Their Own AI to Decode Results and Advice

upvance

Area: Customers & Market WEAK SIGNAL

Patients paste lab results and doctors' notes into general chatbots to understand them, often before any clinician has explained. In the US, 13% of adults have uploaded personal medical information to an AI tool (KFF, 2026).

FORCES

- Results reach patients before the doctor
- People want answers immediately
- Asking privately feels more comfortable
- Appointments are hard to get
- Uploading files and records takes seconds

VALUES

- Immediate understanding over waiting
- Asking privately over asking the clinician
- Arriving prepared over arriving passive
- My own data explained over generic pages
- Convenience over privacy caution

PHASE

Emerging

13% of US adults have uploaded medical data to AI (2026); record-connected health assistants launched only in 2026, US-only.

EXAMPLES

- KFF (US, Feb-Mar 2026): 19% of adults used AI to explain tests, lab results or diagnoses.
- OpenAI (Jul 2026): Health in ChatGPT connects US hospital records, citing 300+ million weekly health questions.
- UMFST Târgu Mureș (Romania, 2025): 31% of online health seekers used chatbots, after Google at 79%.
- PwC (27 countries, 2026): 53% of Romanian respondents use AI as a first source of health information.
- Matthes et al. (4 European countries, 2024): 39.5% used generative AI for health information at least rarely.

INNOVATORS

- OpenAI, the largest amplifier
- Oxford's Andrew Bean and Adam Mahdi tested failures
- UMFST Târgu Mureș measured Romanian chatbot use
- KFF tracks AI use for health

IMPACT

- ▲ Patients arrive with a plain-language reading and written questions, so the visit goes to decisions, not translation.
- ▼ Patients act on a plausible wrong reading; with LLMs, people spotted the right condition in under 34.5% of cases.
- Connecting records gives better answers, but 77% of US adults worry about medical data privacy in AI tools.
- Chatbots tend to confirm self-diagnosis, eroding trust in the doctor, a Romanian physician warns.

RO/EU lens: Romania has the EU's lowest generative AI use (17.8% vs 32.7%, 2025), yet 31% of online health seekers already use chatbots; no RO data on uploading results.

Why it matters: The moment between 'I got a result' and 'I talked to my doctor' is unserved, and patients are already filling it.

Sources: 14 sources, short research, in the Research document